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General Comment

"Artificial Intelligence", as it has been marketed, may be artificial, but it is anything but intelligent. It does not "think", it only does what all other computer processes do: they compute. It happens that the amount of information it computes and vast, but it is incapable of originating a thought, it cannot express an opinion, it does not know, ever, what it is "saying" or "drawing" or anything else. Large Language Models (LLMs) are statistical machines, and that's it.

And yet large corporations and billionaires are hugely invested in making them the Next Big Thing, because they envision them as a way of cutting out the artists and writers, and anyone else creative, from the equation. They see generative "AI" as their ticket to a free money printing machine. In so doing, generative "AI" has been used to plagiarize and steal from thousands upon thousands of artists, writers, and creators in the United States and around the world, and now companies like OpenAI and Google are asking the government to loosen copyright restrictions so that they can keep doing what they've been doing all along: breaking the law.

Many years ago, Americans were chastised for downloading music mp3 files over the then-nascent world wide web via peer-to-peer networks like Napster and Limewire, the common refrain being "You wouldn't download a car!" and similar hokey slogans. And yet, corporations of the present day seem to have no such qualms about stealing droves of digital information created by individuals, all in the hopes that they can finally do away with the pesky artists their AI algorithms are based on. And of course, when you take a vacuum cleaner to the entire searchable internet, you also suck up huge swaths of private information, including medical data, that has no place in any LLM anywhere.

To say nothing of the theft of it all, LLMs require vast amounts of electrical power to run the enormous data centers that make them work, with more data centers with thousands of computers and GPUs churning away to come. This power doesn't come from nowhere, it must be produced, and in doing so we will find ourselves exponentially accelerating the climate change problem, potentially ruining the only world we have, for both billionaires, and for the rest of us.

And it's not even worth it! Image results look terrible. Text "summaries" are filled with nonsense (so-called "hallucinations"). Code is buggy, legal write-ups are filled with non-sequiturs and invented case law. And the reason is, as stated before: generative "AI" does NOT think! It can't think. It will never reach the level of "general" artificial intelligence, because it doesn't even have the intelligence of a fruit fly. It, in fact, has NO intelligence at all. It is just a statistical output machine, worse even than a text messenger's autocomplete function.

Generative "AI" is at best a novel toy, but it cannot "create", and it shouldn't be allowed to operate at all in a world facing the resource and climate problems that we face, both as an individual country, and for the rest of the Earth.